

Страны УЕФА договорились бойкотировать чемпионаты мира из-за планов ФИФА по частным инвестициям



Во вторник стало известно о неоднозначных планах ФИФА, возглавляемой ее президентом Джанни Инфантино. Карл Редайн / Getty Images

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Европейские страны договорились бойкотировать чемпионат мира по футболу из-за планов ФИФА продать доли в турнире частным инвесторам.

в четверг на виртуальной встрече 55 национальных ассоциаций, входящих в УЕФА, Европейскую конфедерацию футбола. Этому предшествовало предложение ФИФА во вторник, согласно которому руководящий орган мирового футбола сообщил 211 ассоциациям-членам, что план должен быть одобрен до 19 сентября.

Позже УЕФА подтвердил свою позицию, заявив, что организация и ее члены «единодушно и безоговорочно отвергают предложение ФИФА о передаче прав собственности на чемпионат мира по футболу и другие соревнования ФИФА частным инвесторам».

«По итогам сегодняшнего обсуждения ни одна национальная сборная УЕФА не будет участвовать ни в одном соревновании ФИФА до тех пор, пока эти предложения не будут полностью отвергнуты и не будут даны твердые гарантии того, что ФИФА никогда больше не будет передавать управление организацией или соревнования в частные руки».

Следующим чемпионатом мира по футболу в календаре станет женский турнир в Бразилии в 2027 году, за которым последует мужской турнир в Испании, Португалии и Марокко в 2030 году. Отборочные матчи женского чемпионата мира, которые организует каждая континентальная конфедерация, должны начаться в октябре.

Конкакаф, футбольная конфедерация Северной, Центральной Америки и Карибского бассейна, заявляет, что отвергает планы ФИФА продать доли в чемпионате мира частным инвесторам.

Один источник, осведомленный об этой встрече, говоривший на условиях анонимности в целях защиты отношений, сказал, что среди подавляющего большинства членов Конкакаф были высказаны чувства и дискуссии о том, что они теряют доверие или вообще утратили доверие к Джанни Инфантино на посту президента ФИФА.

Каковы новые планы?

Во вторник ФИФА подтвердила свое намерение продать значительную долю в новой организации, которую она, как некоммерческая структура, создает для проведения своих главных мероприятий, таких как чемпионаты мира и клубные чемпионаты мира.

Новая организация будет называться FIFA Forward Enterprises (FFE) и возьмет на себя коммерческие операции ФИФА, при этом сама организация останется глобальным руководящим органом мирового футбола и сохранит контрольный пакет акций FFE. В пресс-релизе ФИФА говорится, что организация намерена продать до 21% акций FFE, чтобы выручить 4,2 миллиарда долларов (3,2 миллиарда фунтов стерлингов). Эти деньги могут быть немедленно распределены между ассоциациями-членами.

— and the FIFA Council, the organisation’s decision-making arm made up of the FIFA president, Gianni Infantino, its eight vice presidents and 28 other members. FIFA said on Tuesday this must be done by September 19, in order for funds to become available for its member associations by the start of 2027.

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The intention is to raise \$4.2billion from outside investors, which led to the narrative that FIFA wants to sell (part of) the World Cup

Infantino has spearheaded the idea, and said in the release that “football is the world’s most popular sport and an extraordinary engine of human and social development.”

“Parts of the game have turned that popularity into remarkable commercial value — and we celebrate that success and want it to continue, because it lifts the whole game,” he said. “Our job is to make sure the rest of football grows with it: FIFA exists to support sustainable, inclusive development in every corner of the world.”

On Friday, FIFA added it “acknowledges and respects feedback and concern aired in public” but was pressing on with its proposals, adding that the body “reaffirms its commitment to an open and democratic consultation”.

It said FFE “has been proposed solely to ensure that all FIFA Member Associations (MAS) have the opportunity to take meaningful ownership of the commercial opportunity of football in their respective countries, and that this does not come at the cost of either the spirit or the governance of FIFA or football itself.”

It added: “Nobody is selling football. This is not something FIFA would ever entertain.

“Everyone has the right to express their opposition and to seek further clarification but no single entity can claim to represent all 211 MAS around the world.”

'So long as Europe has a voice, the World Cup will never be for sale'

UEFA's 470-word statement strongly condemned FIFA's idea.

"The World Cup cannot be treated as an investment product," it said. "It is one of football's greatest sporting legacies. It has been built over generations by players, national teams and supporters across every continent. No part of it should ever be surrendered to private investors. The World Cup is not for sale.

"The moment external investors acquire ownership interests in FIFA competitions, football changes forever. Commercial return becomes a permanent obligation. Investor expectations become a daily pressure. From that moment onwards, every decision on the international calendar, every decision on competition formats and every decision shaping the future of football is no longer driven by what best serves the game, but by what best serves shareholders.

"This model has no place in world football. Football's future cannot be dictated by the expectations of those whose first duty is to maximise financial return. Nor can the interests of national associations, leagues, clubs, players and supporters become subordinate to investor returns. Football cannot mortgage its future for financial gain.

"Europe's position is clear. We will never lend this model our legitimacy. No one has the moral authority to sell what they merely hold in trust for the next generation."

“There are moments when institutions are judged not by what they are prepared to accept, but by what they refuse to compromise,” the statement continued. “This is one of those moments.

“Some things are simply too important to sell. The FIFA World Cup belongs to football. It always will. And so long as Europe has a voice, it will never be for sale.”



UEFA is made up of 55 member associations and led by its president, Aleksander Ceferin Pedrag Milosavljevic/AFP via Getty Images

UEFA was also critical of how FIFA's proposal came to light, firstly through a report in the Times of London and then in a press release from world football's governing body: "It is both irresponsible and indefensible that a proposal of such significance for football was conceived in secret and brought to the brink of approval without any meaningful consultation with those entrusted with stewarding the game.

now presented with an ultimatum: accept the irreversible capture of football's greatest competitions or bear the consequences. This is not a 'democratic decision', but governance by intimidation — an act of coercion unworthy of an institution entrusted with the stewardship of the global game."

How the rest of the world reacted

UEFA's public message was quickly followed by statements from several of its member associations, including Norway — which [has often been critical of FIFA and Infantino](#) — England, Scotland and Wales.

On Tuesday, FIFA's plans were met with backlash. Infantino's predecessor Sepp Blatter and UK Prime Minister Andy Burnham were among the critics, while UEFA said the proposal "crosses a line that football's governing institutions should never cross."

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Other continental confederations, though, appeared to initially take more issue with the process FIFA had followed. This included Concacaf, which accused FIFA of a lack of consultation regarding the proposals.

"Concacaf was only made aware of this matter through media reports and, subsequently, via a media release," a statement read. "We are deeply concerned by the lack of due process."

The Asian confederation also said it was "disappointed that a matter of such significance entered the public domain before the AFC family had been afforded the

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The African confederation, however, only commented to confirm its involvement in the consulting process, “encourag(ing) its Member Associations to examine” the proposals themselves.

Infantino subsequently defended the idea on Wednesday in an interview with FIFA, the organisation he leads. In a five-minute video, he said it was a “democratic process” and “strengthening the commercial side of the game is the natural next step in (FIFA’s) evolution.”

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